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20th Meeting

## STATE-WAR-NAVY COORDINATING COMMITTEE

### Minutes of the Meeting held in Room 200, The State Department Building, on Saturday, 11 August 1945, at 1430.

### MEMBERS PRESENT

Mr. James C. Dunn, Chairman

Mr. John J. McCloy

Mr. Artemus L. Gates

### OTHERS PRESENT

**STATE**

Mr. Eugene H. Dooman

Mr. Joseph W. Ballantine

Dr. George H. Blakeslee

Mr. Hugh Borton

Mr. Edward Martin

Mr. Quincy Wright

**WAR**

Brig. General F. N. Roberts

Colonel C. Stanton Babcock

Colonel William C. Chanler

Colonel Harrison A. Gerhardt

Colonel Howard A. Rusk

Lt. Colonel Daniel C. Fahey

Major Davidson Sommers

**NAVY**

Vice Admiral C. M. Cooke, Jr.

Captain Lorenzo S. Sabin

Major Mathias F. Correa, USMC

Lieutenant Merrill Sheppard

Mr. Francis X. Downey

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To SECRET Authority: [illegible] of 5-19-61
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Date 6-15-66

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20th Meeting

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To SECRET Authority: Ltr of 5-19-61
from James P. Burke, State Dept.
Name K. Owens
Date 6-15-66

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BY: NNFD DATE 1-28-72

## SECRETARIAT

Colonel Charles W. McCarthy (War)

Commander Alvin F. Richardson (Navy)

Mr. Harold F. Moseley (State)

Lt. Colonel Paul G. Pennoyer (War)

Lt. Commander John D. Rockefeller, III (Navy)

Lt. Commander John C. Geilfuss (Navy)

Mr. John P. Gardiner (State)

Lieutenant Hugh D. Farley (Navy)

- - -

For Col [illegible]'s file

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14 August 1945

## STATE-WAR-NAVY COORDINATING COMMITTEE

## CORRIGENDUM

## TO

## Minutes of the 20th Meeting of the State-War-Navy Coordinating Committee, Held on Saturday, 11 August 1945, at 1430

Holders of Minutes of the above meeting are requested to attach the enclosed page for page 1 contained therein and destroy the latter by burning.

CHARLES W. McCARTHY
ALVIN F. RICHARDSON
RAYMOND E. COX
Secretariat

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## 1. COMMUNICATIONS TO UNITED KINGDOM, USSR AND CHINA CONCERNING SUPREME COMMANDER

MR. McCLOY circulated separate draft communications to the United Kingdom, Soviet and Chinese Governments with respect to the designation of General MacArthur as Supreme Commander of the Allied Powers to accept, coordinate and carry into effect the Japanese surrender, and the designation of representatives of each to be present with him. These documents, he explained, were prepared at the request of Secretary of State Byrnes. He pointed out that each communication set forth in general terms the Japanese forces which are to surrender to its designated commander, these provisions to be made specific later in General Order No. 1. He also pointed out that each of the communications included a statement that it was assumed that this procedure would be acceptable and that preliminary instructions were being issued to General MacArthur. He stated also that the War Department, with the approval of Mr. Byrnes, was communicating this information to General MacArthur.

In response to a question by MR. GATES, MR. McCLOY stated that he was informed that the selection of General MacArthur as Supreme Commander had been directed by President Truman.

THE COMMITTEE approved these three draft communications, on behalf of their respective departments, and agreed that they be delivered to the Secretary of State.

## 2. INSTRUMENT OF SURRENDER, DIRECTIVE TO SUPREME COMMANDER AND GENERAL ORDER NO. 1

MR. McCLOY stated that it had been determined this morning not to have the Emperor sign the surrender instrument and that the note sent to the Japanese had been revised accordingly. This, he stated, required revision of the instrument of surrender. He presented redrafts of (1) the Instrument of Surrender, (2) the Directive to the Supreme Commander for the Allied Powers to be signed by President Truman, and (3) General Order No. 1 to be issued by the Japanese Imperial General Headquarters at the direction of the Supreme Commander for the Allied Powers. He stated that these documents had been approved by the War Department and requested their prompt consideration by the State and

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Navy Departments.

He explained that the term "Imperial General Headquarters" had been substituted for "High Command" in all documents as a result of research by the War and Navy members of the Joint Staff Planners. He also stated that the draft General Order No. 1 was intended to be forwarded to General MacArthur with instructions to use it as a guide rather than as a document to be literally adhered to, thus giving him the authority to alter it to meet circumstances as they exist at the time of issuance.

THE COMMITTEE agreed that these three documents be processed by the Secretariat as a paper in the SWNCC 21 series for consideration by the Committee.

3. FURTHER COMMUNICATION TO THE JAPANESE

MR. McCLOY presented a draft of a further communication to the Japanese Government to be transmitted after receipt of agreement by the Japanese to the note transmitted to it this morning and after agreement by the three Allies to the proposals contained in the communications to be addressed to them (Item 1). This communication sets forth the steps to be taken at once by the Japanese Government. It will not be cleared with our Allies but copies will be sent them after transmission.

THE COMMITTEE approved this draft communication to the Japanese Government.

4. UNITED STATES INITIAL POST-DEFEAT POLICY RELATING TO JAPAN (SWNCC 150)

MR. McCLOY presented a redraft of the paper on United States Initial Post-Defeat Policy Relating to Japan. He indicated he desired time to study this document further, and both GENERAL ROBERTS and MR. DOOMAN stated that they had revisions to suggest.

THE COMMITTEE agreed to defer consideration of this paper, instructed the Subcommittee for the Far East to prepare a further revision to be considered by the Committee at a meeting to be held tomorrow, Sunday, 12 August 1945, at 1000.